

Word family: **day / days / daily / daytime / daylight / day-to-day**

Base word: day

Plural: days

Related forms / useful extensions: daily, daytime, daylight, day-to-day

Important expressions: every day, one day, the other day, all day, day by day, from day to day, day off, make someone's day, call it a day

Part of speech: mainly noun (名詞), with related adjective/adverb forms

Your passage:

> “At that time, I was commuting **every day** ...”

A full family sweep shows that **day has several useful meanings**, but many grow from one central idea: **a unit or period of time associated with one cycle of daytime and nighttime**.

We should distinguish:

1. a calendar/24-hour day;
2. daylight hours;
3. a particular date/occasion;
4. a working/school day;
5. an era or period in someone's life/history;
6. several very common fixed expressions.

Meaning in your passage

Here:

> **every day**

means:

on each day; daily; every single day as a repeated routine.

繁體中文： ** 每天；每一日；每日都如此

Natural translation:

> “I was commuting every day.”

「我當時**每天都要通勤**。」

Here:

****day** = 日曆上的一天；every day = 每一天都發生******

1. ****day** = 24-hour/calendar period (時間單位) — 一天；一日******

This is the core meaning in your passage.

Practice 1 — Original

> “I was commuting ****every day****.”

「我當時****每天****都要通勤。」

Practice 2

> “The package should arrive within three ****days****.”

「包裹應該會在三****天****內送到。」

Practice 3

> “There are seven ****days**** in a week.”

「一星期有七****天****。」

****day** = 從一天到下一天的一個基本日曆時間單位，通常約為二十四小時******

2. ****day** = daytime / hours of light (白天) — 白天；日間******

Here, ****day**** contrasts with ****night****.

Practice 4

> “It was warm during the ****day**** but cold at night.”

「****白天****很暖，但晚上很冷。」

Practice 5

> “The streets are much busier in the ****day****.”

「街道在****日間****繁忙得多。」

****day** = 從早上到晚上、天空有日光的那段時間，與 night 相對******

This is genuinely different from the full 24-hour meaning.

3. ****day** = particular date/occasion (某一天 / 某個重要日子) — 日子 ; 某一天******

****Meaning:**** A specific day associated with an event or occasion.

Practice 6

> “The wedding ****day**** was unforgettable.”

「婚禮那****一天 / 那個日子****令人難忘。」

Practice 7

> “It was the happiest ****day**** of my life.”

「那是我人生中最快樂的****一天****。」

****day** = 因某件事情發生而被視為一個特定日期 / 日子的時間點******

4. ****day** = work/school period (工作 / 上課) — 工作日 ; 一天的工作 / 上課時間******

****Meaning:**** The period during which someone works, studies, or performs their normal daily duties.

Practice 8

> “I had a long ****day**** at work.”

「我今天有一個很漫長的****工作日 / 工作了一整天****。」

Practice 9

> “She starts her working ****day**** at eight.”

「她早上八時開始一天的****工作時間****。」

****day** = 一天之中用來工作、上課或履行日常職責的時間段******

This gives us phrases such as:

- * working day = 工作日
- * school day = 上課日
- * business day = 工作日 / 營業日

5. **day = period/era in history or someone's life (時代 / 年代) — 時代 ; 年代 ; 當年**

This is an important figurative extension.

Practice 10

> “In my **day**, people didn't use smartphones.”

「在我**那個年代 / 當年**，人們還不用智能電話。」

Practice 11

> “Those inventions were advanced for their **day**.”

「那些發明以**當時那個時代**來說非常先進。」

day = 某個人的人生階段或歷史中的特定時期 / 年代

So:

> **in my day**

= **在我那個年代 / 我年輕的時候**

6. **one day = at some unspecified time (某一天) — 有一天 ; 總有一天**

This expression can refer either to the **past** or **future**.

Past

> “**One day**, I saw him at the station.”

「**有一天**，我在車站看到他。」

Future

> “I hope to visit Japan **one day**.”

「我希望**有一天** / 將來某一天**去日本**。」

one day = 某個未明確指定的日子；可指過去某一天或未來某一天

Context determines which.

7. **the other day** = a few days ago (最近某天) — 前幾天；日前

A very common expression.

Practice 12

> “I saw her **the other day**.”

「我**前幾天**見到她。」

Practice 13

> “We were talking about that **the other day**.”

「我們**前幾天**才談過那件事。」

the other day = 距離現在不久之前的某一天

It does not mean literally 「另一日」.

8. **all day** = throughout the whole day — 一整天；整天

Practice 14

> “I wore the headphones **all day**.”

「我**整天**都戴著耳機。」

Practice 15

> “It rained **all day**.”

「雨下了**一整天**。」

****all day = 從一天較早時候一直持續到較晚時候，幾乎整個白天 / 整日****

9. ****day by day = gradually as each day passes — 一天天地；逐日****

Practice 16

> “Her confidence grew ****day by day****.”

「她的信心****一天一天地 / 逐日****增加。」

Practice 17

> “The situation improved ****day by day****.”

「情況****逐日****改善。」

****day by day = 隨著每一天過去，情況逐漸發生變化****

10. ****from day to day = from one day to the next / without long-term certainty — 每天；過一天算一天****

This has two related uses.

A. One day to the next

> “Conditions change ****from day to day****.”

「情況****每天都可能不同****。」

B. No long-term planning/certainty

> “They were living ****from day to day****.”

「他們過著****過一天算一天、沒有長遠保障的生活****。」

****from day to day = 每天之間不斷變化；亦可指只顧眼前、沒有長遠安排****

11. ****day off = day when you do not work/study — 休息日；不用上班的一天****

A very useful compound expression.

Practice 18

> “Friday is my **day off**.”

「星期五是我的**休息日**。」

Practice 19

> “I took a **day off** to rest.”

「我請了一**天假**休息。」

day off = 原本可能需要工作 / 上課，但獲安排不用工作的那一天**

12. **daily** = happening every day (每天發生) — 每日的；每天的**

Daily is the most important related adjective.

Practice 20

> “Commuting was part of my **daily** routine.”

「通勤是我**每日例行生活**的一部分。」

Practice 21

> “The app sends a **daily** reminder.”

「這個應用程式每天會發出一個**每日提醒**。」

daily — adjective = 每一天都會發生、進行或出現的**

13. **daily** = every day (副詞) — 每天；每日**

Practice 22

> “The trains run **daily**.”

「火車**每天**行駛。」

Practice 23

> “The system is checked ****daily****.”

「系統會****每日****檢查。」

****daily — adverb = 每一天一次或每一天都發生****

Compare:

> every day = everyday conversational expression

> daily = slightly more concise/formal

14. ****daily = newspaper published every day (名詞) — 日報****

This is a useful noun meaning.

Practice 24

> “She writes for a national ****daily****.”

「她為一家全國性的****日報****撰稿。」

Practice 25

> “Several local ****dailies**** reported the story.”

「幾家本地****日報****都報道了這則新聞。」

****a daily = 每天出版的報紙****

This is more common in journalism/media language.

15. ****daytime = period during daylight hours — 日間；白天****

Practice 26

> “The temperature is higher during the ****daytime****.”

「****日間 / 白天****氣溫較高。」

Practice 27

> “The restaurant is quieter in the **daytime**.”

「這間餐廳在**日間**比較安靜。」

daytime = 從早上至傍晚、有日光的時間段

This overlaps with **day = daytime**, but **daytime** makes the contrast with night explicit.

16. **daytime** + noun (節目 / 活動 / 工作) — 日間的；白天進行的

Practice 28

> “She works **daytime hours**.”

「她在**日間時段**工作。」

Practice 29

> “The programme has a large **daytime audience**.”

「這個節目有很多**日間觀眾**。」

daytime + noun = 在白天時段發生、使用或觀看的

17. **daylight** = natural light from the sun during the day — 日光；天然光

A useful family extension.

Practice 30

> “The room gets plenty of natural **daylight**.”

「這個房間有充足的天然**日光**。」

Practice 31

> “We should leave before **daylight** fades.”

「我們應該在**日光**消失之前離開。」

daylight = 白天由太陽提供的自然光線

18. **daylight = daytime / when it is light outside — 天亮；白晝**

Practice 32

> “We reached the village before **daylight**.”

「我們在**天亮之前**到達村莊。」

Practice 33

> “They waited until **daylight** to continue.”

「他們等到**天亮**才繼續前進。」

daylight = 外面已有自然光、屬於白天的狀態 / 時段

19. **day-to-day = ordinary everyday / routine (生活 / 管理) — 日常的；每日例行的**

Practice 34

> “She handles the **day-to-day** management of the office.”

「她負責辦公室的**日常管理工作**。」

Practice 35

> “Noise affected my **day-to-day** life.”

「噪音影響了我的**日常生活**。」

day-to-day = 與每天例行生活、工作或實際運作有關的

This is different from **everyday**, though they often overlap.

20. **make someone's day = make someone very happy — 令某人整天心情大好；令某人非常開心**

A very common idiom.

Practice 36

> “Your message really **made my day**.”

「你的訊息真的**令我非常開心 / 讓我整天心情都很好**。」

Practice 37

> “Winning the prize **made her day**.”

「贏得獎品令她**整天都非常開心**。」

make someone's day = 某件事令某人感到特別開心，甚至令那一天變得格外美好

21. **call it a day** = stop working for now — 今天先做到這裡；收工

Another very common idiom.

Practice 38

> “We’ve done enough. Let’s **call it a day**.”

「我們做得差不多了，**今天先做到這裡吧**。」

Practice 39

> “After six hours of editing, we decided to **call it a day**.”

「編輯了六個小時後，我們決定**收工 / 今天先停下來**。」

call it a day = 決定停止目前的工作或活動，通常因為已經做得夠多

Important distinction: **day vs daytime**

day

can mean:

- * 24 hours;
- * daytime;
- * a date;
- * an era.

daytime

specifically means:

****the part of the day when it is light outside****

> “I work during the day.”

「我白天工作。」

> “I work in the daytime.”

「我在日間工作。」

Very similar in this context.

Important distinction: ****day vs date****

day

can mean the general day or day of the week.

> “What day is the meeting?”

Possible answer:

> “Friday.”

date

usually asks for the calendar date.

> “What’s the date?”

Possible answer:

> “September 17.”

So:

****day = 星期幾 / 哪一天****

****date = 幾月幾日****

Context matters.

Important distinction: **every day** vs **everyday**

You already curated **everyday**, but this contrast is essential here.

every day

two words; adverbial phrase:

= **每天**

> “I commute **every day**.”

「我每天通勤。」

everyday

one word; adjective:

= **日常的 / 普通的**

> “Commuting is part of **everyday life**.”

「通勤是日常生活的一部分。」

This is one of the most important spelling/grammar distinctions in your passage.

Important distinction: **daily** vs **every day**

every day

normal conversational phrase.

> “I use them every day.”

daily

can be an adverb or adjective and often sounds slightly more concise/formal.

> “I use them daily.”

Both:

「我每天使用它們。」

But:

> **daily routine** ✓

not:

> **every day routine** ✗

Instead:

> **everyday routine** or **daily routine**

Important distinction: **day vs night**

day

can mean the light part of the 24-hour cycle.

night

means the dark period, usually from evening until morning.

> “The train is busy during the day but quiet at night.”

「火車白天繁忙，晚上則較安靜。」

Important distinction: **working day vs business day**

These often overlap.

working day

a day when people normally work.

business day

especially in banking/contracts/logistics:

a day counted for business operations, generally excluding weekends and specified holidays.

> “Delivery takes three business days.”

「送貨需要三個工作日。」

Family-extension sweep

After the full sweep, the useful modern family includes:

* **day — 24-hour/calendar unit** = 一天
* **day — daylight period** = 白天
* **day — particular occasion/date** = 某一天 / 日子
* **day — work/school period** = 工作日 / 一天工作時間
* **day — era** = 時代 / 年代
* **one day** = 有一天 / 總有一天
* **the other day** = 前幾天
* **all day** = 一整天
* **day by day** = 一天天地 / 逐日
* **from day to day** = 每天之間；過一天算一天
* **day off** = 休息日 / 一天假
* **daily — adjective/adverb** = 每日的 / 每天
* **a daily** = 日報
* **daytime** = 日間 / 白天
* **daylight** = 日光 / 天亮
* **day-to-day** = 日常的 / 每日例行的
* **make someone's day** = 令某人非常開心
* **call it a day** = 今天先做到這裡 / 收工

There are many compounds beginning with **day-**—such as **daydream, daycare, daybreak**—but I would not automatically include all of them because that would turn the family sweep into a compound dictionary. They should be added only if their meanings become directly useful.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
-----	-----
day — 24-hour period	日曆中從一天到下一天的一個基本時間單位，約二十四小時
day — daytime	從早上到晚上、有日光的時間，與夜晚相對
day — occasion/date	因特定事件發生而被視為某個具體日子
day — working/school period	一天中用來工作、上課或履行日常職責的時間段
day — era	某個人的人生階段或歷史中的特定年代 / 時期
one day	過去或未來某個未明確指定的日子

the other day	距離現在不久之前的某一天 / 前幾天	
all day	幾乎整個一天持續如此	
day by day	隨著每一天過去而逐漸改變	
from day to day	每天情況不同；亦可指只顧眼前、沒有長遠安排	
day off	原本可能工作 / 上課，但不用工作的休息日	
daily — adjective/adverb	每一天都發生 / 每日的；每天	
a daily	每天出版一次的報紙 / 日報	
daytime	白天有日光的時間段	
daylight	白天由太陽提供的自然光；亦可指天亮的狀態	
day-to-day	與每日例行生活、管理或實際運作有關的	
make someone's day	某件事令某人非常開心，使那一天變得特別美好	
call it a day	決定停止目前的工作 / 活動，今天先做到這裡	

For your original sentence

> “At that time, I was commuting ****every day****...”

The exact meaning is:

****day = 日曆上的一天****

and:

> ****every day****

= ****每一天 / 每天****

So:

> “I was commuting every day.”

= ****「我當時每天都要通勤。」****

And the crucial spelling distinction remains:

> ****every day**** = 每天

> ****everyday**** = 日常的 / 普通的